

Hong Kong: PMI increased in June

Bottom line:

The S&P Global Hong Kong PMI (which covers the manufacturing, construction, wholesale, retail and services sectors) increased from 50.4 in May to 52.0 in June. Among the major components of the PMI, the largest increase in June came from the new orders sub-index. External demand remained solid, while margin pressure in downstream sectors persisted in June.

Key numbers:

S&P Global Hong Kong PMI: 52.0 in June, vs. 50.4 in May

Main points:

1. The S&P Global Hong Kong PMI increased from 50.4 in May to 52.0 in June. Among the major components of the PMI, the largest increase in June came from the new orders sub-index (53.2 vs. 50.1 in May). S&P Global commented that new product launches, improved client demand, and greater spending amid the World Cup had boosted sales. The supply delivery sub-index fell to 47.8 (vs. 49.4 in May), indicating slower deliveries, which mechanically boosted the headline reading. The inventory sub-index rose to 51.7 (vs. 50.3 in May). The output sub-index increased to 52.7 in June (vs. 51.6 in May), and the employment sub-index edged up to 49.4 (vs. 49.2 in May).
2. External demand remained solid in June. The new export orders sub-index fell to 51.8 in June (vs. 53.0 in May), but remained above 50. The “new business from China” sub-index increased to 52.1 (vs. 49.2 in May).
3. Margin pressure on downstream sectors persisted in June. The input price sub-index fell to 55.3 (vs. 57.6 in May), but remained elevated. The labor cost sub-index edged up to 52.4 (vs. 51.6 in May). The output price sub-index fell to 52.1 (vs. 52.8 in May). S&P Global mentioned that companies partially passed on higher expenses to customers by raising their selling prices, while others offered discounts to clear inventories and support sales.

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Source: S&P Global

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